Rationale:

We have learned that a work is intended to not only entertain the audience, but also to influence them in some significant way. I will be writing a short story which shows how sections of *Hamlet* by William Shakespeare convey a theme of contemplation to the audience. I chose this format because it allows me to use a similar style to the one used in Hamlet. The tone and themes in my task are intended to be similar to the original text. There are also linguistic choices that mimic the style of Shakespeare, particularly for the characters I have chosen to write about.

The intended audience is someone who is already familiar with the play of Hamlet, as the story is a continuation of the original story. It features two gravediggers who briefly appeared in the text, who are now digging the graves for the characters who died at the end of Hamlet. Their discussion will mainly consist of ways that they would have taken different actions from the main characters, and their reasoning for making those actions. Focusing on these subjects will convey to the reader the ways that Shakespeare influenced the audience with Hamlet.

Word Count: 218

Essay:
[Enter two gravediggers, Damon and Gilbert]

Damon: Oh the tragedy of these fair people's deaths!

Gilbert: Tragedy? Why does thou propose it as such?

Damon: Their deaths came to them years before
Any of them did deserve it.

Gilbert: Save for the murderous king.

Damon: Aye, the killer king does entitle himself
To an early demise.

Gilbert: On second consideration, my friend,
I would deem their deaths as quite the expected
Consequence for their misguided actions.

Damon: What actions were misguided such
that they should earn the doer a place in the ground?

Gilbert: Well take this prince for instance.
He had soley known of the king's corruption, and
Yet waited far too long before enacting any sort ot
Plan to stop his improper rule.

Damon: He made the choices that appeared
Correct to him.

Gilbert: If I were in the position of that prince
Hamlet I would still be walking above the ground
On this very day.

Damon: By what means would thou achieve this?

Gilbert: I would enact on killing the guilty
Before he was ever aware I had plans
Of such.

Damon: Dost thou not see the body of
Good Laertes laying 20 paces there.

Gilbert: How does the man stabbed of his
Own sword have relation to avoiding dying
The prince's death?

Damon: He made haste with avenging
Of his father, as thou suggests one should,
And he now lies with the rest of them.

Gilbert: His thoughts were manipulated
By the corrupt king.

Damon: Who only made use of his mind
Primed and willing to kill in the name of
Vengeance for his father.

Gilbert: So one should wait as to avoid being
Misguided by the evil? If thou dost not act
Immediately to such a tragedy, how would it
Ever be that the death is avenged?

Damon: One can postpone action without stalling
Until their death to act.

Gilbert: Aye, that is the most crucial detail
For one would not wish to act as Hamlet who
Only completed his task after death was
Knocking on the walls of his faltering heart.

Damon: The unfortunate soul who waited
For the last of his breaths before making
His first move. 'Twas his most major of flaws.
The Lord heard his father's commands
for vengeance, and contemplated the factuality.
He made not even the slightest haste for to
Resolve his question, Instead waiting

for opportunity to place itself in his uncertain
lap. He must have been overjoyed when the
Actors appeared at the castle before him,
Prepared to act in whichever way he wished.
Even after he had acquired a full encyclopedia
Of evidence, he restrained himself from doing
As he was told! For what purpose? Why would a
Man allow his father's soul to suffer while he
Debates within himself the importance of life.
Methinks it would invoke more madness than
Anything else this world could possibly conjure!

Gilbert: Madness it must have caused for him to
Stab a man who hadn't any involvement in the
Murder!

Damon: While he punished his mother for a crime
That he was told she couldn't be blamed for.

Gilbert: It makes nearly as much sense as a man
Who was so conflicted over taking a single life
Leaving this many bodies for us to drop into
the ground.

Damon: Aye, 'tis the life of making homes for
The dead.

Gilbert: A job without even the slightest of
Entertainment in 't.

Damon: Now that is a fact easily changed.
[*sings*] The king, the queen, a brother
and-a son. Mix in corruption and they
all are a-done. The ground their home,
The coffin their bed. They'll lie for
eternity, 'till e'eryone else is dead.

Gilbert: Dost thou think it be a little morbid?

Damon: Only as morbid as the scene that was
Witnessed in the castle.

Gilbert: But how does thou joke about death
As though it is a problem that does not plague
Your very being?

Damon: Laying cold corpses in the ever slightly
warmer earth for years as many as I
Removes all questions of how I will be after death.
I know will be rotten.

Gilbert: That fear have been strucketh from mine
Self also, dost thou not consider the fate of thy
Soul?

Damon: Apparently my soul shalt be condemned in
Instructing my son to murder my imaginary brother.

Gilbert: Away from your childness, methinks that
What the mind decides during life will leave
Permanent scars on the soul.

Damon: Then thou must gravely fear all actions in life
As much as thou fears death itself.

Gilbert: Aye. It is the both that cause me to waffle
Many times daily. 'Tis most likely the reason I have
Acquired myself a job of such high honor and respect.

Damon: Heed caution in jesting on thine own life
In that manner; it may cause scars on thy soul.
Thou shouldst be weary of falling the same
To the same unending contemplation as Hamlet.

Gilbert: The consideration of taking my own life
Will not be a solution to any problem this existence
lobs my direction. In which way is thou perspective any
More successful than mine own? It is certain that

One of the bodies encircling us reckoned in the
Same sense.

Damon: ‘Tis true that a body near to us thinks
In the same manner as I, the distinction is in his
Beating heart, and the crown which now rests
on his head.

Word Count: 904

Works Cited

Shakespeare, William. Hamlet. Edited by Jeff Dolven, Barnes & Noble, 2007.